

Ian Ochieng

Full-Stack & Backend Developer

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PROFILE

Full-stack and backend developer working in JavaScript, Node.js, Go, SQL and Docker. I build software for specific business problems, from internal tools backed by a database to production platforms for client businesses. I'm currently a software development apprentice at Zone01 Kisumu, and I bring a background in Public Administration and Sociology to how I scope what a system needs to do.

SKILLS

Languages	Go, JavaScript, Java, SQL, Solidity, HTML5/CSS3
Frameworks	Node.js, Express.js, Spring Boot, React, React Native/Expo
Infrastructure	Docker, Linux, GitHub Actions, Prometheus, Grafana, SQLite
Tools	Git & GitHub, gRPC, OpenAPI, Hardhat

EXPERIENCE

Software Development Apprentice — Zone01 Kisumu

Mar 2026 – Present

Project-based, peer-driven apprenticeship (training programme)

- Backend contributor on Flexi-Ride, a team-built ride-hailing platform of 13 Java/Spring Boot microservices. I standardised the Docker builds, defined gRPC and OpenAPI contracts, locked down Actuator management endpoints, and set up Prometheus and Grafana monitoring.
- Built DawaTrace, a pharmaceutical-verification prototype on Solidity smart contracts, at a Zone01 hackathon.
- Built Clonernews (pair project), a Hacker News reader with live updates, request caching and retry with backoff, in plain JavaScript.
- Team member on Sortable, a searchable, paginated data table with unit-aware sorting.
- Wrote go-reloaded, a Go command-line text-transformation pipeline.

Freelance Software Developer

Ongoing

Self-employed · Client work

- Built the production website, SEO and backend services for Ben's Tailoring, a Qatar-based tailoring business, as sole developer.
- Built Duka Ledger, an installment-payment tracker for small shop owners (Node.js, Express, SQLite).

PERSONAL PROJECTS

SemaKazi

Node.js · Express · SQLite · JWT

- Skills-verification and reputation platform for Kenya's informal-sector workers, built on three trust signals: photo proof of jobs, client ratings and peer-endorsed skill badges.
- Scoped the MVP in a written PRD. Registration, search, profiles with reviews and the worker dashboard work end to end.

Duka POS

Node.js · Express · EJS · SQLite

- Offline point-of-sale and inventory system for small shops, with owner and cashier roles, barcode scanning, receipts, low-stock alerts and multi-shop support.
- Stock is deducted atomically at checkout to prevent overselling. Covered by a 20-test suite.

AuraRisk

Go · PostgreSQL · React · Expo

- Climate-risk platform with localised flood risk scores, early warnings and community reports, on web and mobile.
- Removed default credentials and made production fail fast on unsafe config. Added caching, retries, a circuit breaker and stale-data fallback for the weather API, plus rate limits, request IDs and graceful shutdown.

WRITING

Technical articles on Dev.to, including a three-part series on building SemaKazi and posts on Docker multi-stage builds and debugging Expo on Linux. Engineering notes on my portfolio cover security, reliability and observability work on Flexi-Ride, AuraRisk, SemaKazi and Clonernews.

EDUCATION

Software Development Apprenticeship — Zone01 Kisumu

Mar 2026 – Present

B.A. Public Administration, major in Sociology

University of Nairobi